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Covering all 6 revenue streams · All growth stages · Partnership roles · Monthly operating costs

How to Read This Document

For every revenue stream and every operational area, this document answers three questions: **(1) What skills are needed? (2) Should you learn it yourself, hire someone, or outsource it? (3) What does it cost and why?**

Skills are divided into **must-have** (the business breaks without them), **high-value** (significantly accelerates revenue), and **nice-to-have** (improves quality but can be deferred).

The honest starting point: Right now you are a one-person operation running a sophisticated multi-country platform. That means you are the developer, the salesperson, the marketer, the customer support rep, and the CEO. This plan tells you the exact order in which to delegate each function as revenue grows — so you buy back your time at the highest possible return.

Skills Required Per Revenue Stream

Stream 1: Employer Job Postings

Selling job posting packages to companies. Your highest-value revenue stream.

Skill	Priority	Description	Learn or Hire?	Cost if Hired
B2B Sales (WhatsApp & phone)	MUST-HAVE	Cold outreach to HR managers. Pitch → demo → close. Following up without being annoying.	Learn first, hire at Month 3	K1,500–3,000/mo + 10% commission
Copywriting	HIGH VALUE	Writing compelling pitch messages, email sequences, landing page copy for employer packages	Learn (use AI tools to assist)	K500–1,500/mo if outsourced
CRM / pipeline management	HIGH VALUE	Tracking leads, follow-ups, deal stages. A simple spreadsheet works at first.	Learn (free tools: Notion, HubSpot free)	\$0–\$50/mo (tools)
Objection handling	MUST-HAVE	"We use LinkedIn" / "We already have a recruiter" / "Your platform is too new" — know your answers cold.	Learn (this document gives you the answers)	\$0
Invoice & payment admin	OPERATIONAL	Sending invoices, following up on payments, reconciling accounts	Learn (already built into the platform)	\$0

Objection cheat sheet: "We use LinkedIn" → "LinkedIn charges R5,000+/month and reaches mostly professional network, not active job seekers. We charge R250 for the same reach plus WhatsApp delivery." | "Too new" → "New means your job gets seen first — no backlog. We have 19,000 live listings and growing 375 jobs/day."

Stream 2: VIP WhatsApp Alerts

Selling personalised job alert subscriptions to job seekers. Already running — needs scaling.

Skill	Priority	Description	Learn or Hire?	Cost
WhatsApp community management	MUST-HAVE	Responding to subscriber queries, handling complaints, onboarding new subscribers	Learn — 1–2 hours/day initially	\$0
Conversion copywriting	HIGH VALUE	Writing the ad copy and welcome messages that convince someone to pay K20–K120 for an alert subscription	Learn (high ROI skill — 1 good message = 100 conversions)	\$0
Facebook Ads management	MUST-HAVE	Running lead generation campaigns targeting job seekers. Facebook Business Manager, audience targeting, A/B testing ad copy.	Learn first. Outsource to a freelancer at Month 4 if budget allows.	K1,500–3,000/mo if outsourced
Subscription customer support	HIGH VALUE	Handling "I haven't received alerts", "How do I change my filters", renewal reminders	Part-time hire at 50+ subscribers	K800–1,500/mo part-time

Stream 3: Career Services

CV review, rewriting, interview coaching. High margin, builds trust.

Skill	Priority	Description	Learn or Hire?	Cost
Professional CV writing	MUST-HAVE	ATS-optimised CVs, professional formatting, accomplishment framing ("increased sales by 40%" not "responsible for sales")	Outsource to a freelance CV writer. Pay per CV. You manage the customer.	K80–150/CV to writer. You charge K350. Profit: K200.
HR / recruitment knowledge	HIGH VALUE	Understanding what hiring managers look for. ATS keywords. Industry-specific norms.	Learn via free resources (LinkedIn Learning has free HR courses)	\$0
Interview coaching	NICE TO HAVE	STAR method coaching, mock interview sessions, body language, salary negotiation	Partner with an experienced HR professional on commission	Share 30–40% of K400 session fee = K120–160/session
AI prompt engineering	HIGH VALUE	Getting the best CV feedback from the Claude AI already integrated in your platform. Better prompts = better output = happier clients.	Learn (you already have this partially via the platform)	\$0

Stream 4: Salary Reports

Data products from your job listing database. High margin, zero marginal cost once written.

Skill	Priority	Description	Learn or Hire?	Cost
Data analysis (basic)	MUST-HAVE	Querying your DB (SQL), exporting job listing data by category/location/frequency, spotting trends	Learn — you already write SQL for the platform	\$0
Report writing	MUST-HAVE	Turning raw data into a readable narrative. "Finance & Accounting roles in Zambia increased 23% YoY, concentrated in Lusaka (67% of postings)."	Learn (1 week per report). Use AI to draft.	\$0
Basic graphic design	HIGH VALUE	Charts, cover page, infographics. Canva Pro covers 95% of this at K220/month.	Learn (Canva is extremely easy)	K220/month (Canva Pro)
B2B data sales	HIGH VALUE	Selling bespoke reports to NGOs, development banks, government, consultancies. Requires proposal writing and executive-level pitching.	Learn (start with standard reports, build up to bespoke)	\$0

Stream 5: WhatsApp Channel Sponsorship

Selling ad placements in your automated job posting channels. Pure media sales.

Skill	Priority	Description	Learn or Hire?	Cost
Media sales	MUST-HAVE	Approaching marketing managers at companies to sponsor your WhatsApp channel. "We post 100+ jobs/day to 5,000 subscribers in SA — your brand on every post for R1,500/month."	Commission-based sales rep — same person as employer sales ideally	15–20% of deal value
Audience analytics	HIGH VALUE	Knowing your channel subscriber count, engagement rates, open rates. Sponsors buy on numbers.	Learn — Whapi provides analytics via API	\$0
Sponsorship proposal writing	HIGH VALUE	One-page media kit: audience demographics, reach numbers, pricing, testimonials	DIY using Canva + data from your platform	K220/month (Canva, shared with salary reports)

Stream 6: Featured Listings & Data API

Skill	Priority	Description	Learn or Hire?	Cost
Technical API documentation	HIGH VALUE	Writing clear API docs for companies that want to pull your job data. Postman collections, endpoint docs, rate limit explanations.	Learn (you already know the codebase)	\$0
Enterprise sales / negotiation	NICE TO HAVE	Closing \$200–\$2,000 data licensing deals with HR platforms and enterprise clients	Hire at Stage 2 — enterprise sales rep	\$500–1,500/mo + commission

Stage 1 — Solo Operator (Now → Month 6)

You do most things yourself. You hire only commission-based roles that pay for themselves immediately.

YOU (Founder) — The role you cannot outsource yet

Your job at this stage: Product owner, developer, sales, customer support, and marketing director all in one.

Function	Time Per Week	Tools
Employer outreach (WhatsApp cold messages)	5–8 hrs	Your phone, exported company list from DB
VIP alert customer support	2–3 hrs	WhatsApp, admin panel
Facebook ad management	2–3 hrs	Facebook Business Manager
Technical maintenance and fixes	4–6 hrs	Laravel, server, Claude Code
Salary report writing	3–5 hrs (monthly)	SQL, Canva, Google Docs
Social media content	1–2 hrs	Automated — minimal manual work needed
Finance, invoicing, admin	2–3 hrs	Platform invoice system, spreadsheet
Total	~20-30 hrs/week	Sustainable alongside a day job initially

First Hire: Commission-Only Sales Rep (Month 1-2)

Why: You cannot both build the product and do outbound sales at scale. One rep making 30 calls/day is worth more than you making 5. Commission-only means zero fixed cost risk.

Item	Detail
Role title	Business Development Rep (or "Sales Agent")
What they do	Cold WhatsApp / call outreach to Zambian companies. Present employer packages. Close deals. Hand off to you for onboarding.
Skills required	Confident communicator, basic HR/recruitment knowledge, persistent. Does NOT need to be technical.
Where to find them	University graduates in business/marketing, ex-recruitment agency staff, LinkedIn Zambia
Compensation	K0 retainer + 15% commission on every deal closed. On 10 deals at K500 avg = K750/month earnings for them.
Cost to you	K750/month (15% of K5,000 revenue) — pays for itself 6.7× over
Management	30-minute weekly check-in. Provide script and objection responses. Track deals in a shared spreadsheet.

Second Hire: Freelance CV Writer (Month 2-3)

Why: Career services revenue is high-margin but requires skill you may not have at professional level. A K80–150 per-CV cost produces K350 revenue — a 133–338% margin.

Item	Detail
Role	Freelance CV Writer / Career Coach
Skills required	Professional CV writing, ATS knowledge, ideally HR background. Degree in HR, business, or equivalent experience.
Where to find	LinkedIn Zambia, local universities (HR lecturers moonlight), ex-recruitment agencies
Compensation	K100–150 per CV delivered (you set deadline: 48 hours). K200–300 for full rewrite + cover letter.
Cost to you	Variable. At 10 orders/month: K1,000–1,500 cost, K3,500 revenue. Net: K2,000–2,500.

How to manage	Send them the customer brief + CV file via WhatsApp. They deliver Word doc. You review, deliver to customer.
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Stage 2 — Small Team (Month 6-12)

You have proven the model. Now you hire to scale, not to survive.

Role	When	Salary (ZMW)	What They Unlock	Justification
Part-time Marketing Assistant	Month 5-6	K2,500-4,000/mo	Facebook ads, social content, email campaigns	Frees 10+ hrs/week for you. At K50,000/month revenue, this is 5-8% of revenue.
SA Sales Rep (remote)	Month 4-5	R0 retainer + 12% commission	SA employer acquisition — your biggest market	SA revenue potential (K35,000/month yr1 target) justifies a dedicated rep. Commission-only removes salary risk.
Customer Support (part-time)	Month 6	K1,500-2,500/mo	VIP alert subscribers, career service clients, employer queries	At 100+ VIP subscribers and 20+ career service clients/month, support is 15+ hrs/week. Too much for you.
Bookkeeper (part-time)	Month 6	K1,000-2,000/mo	Multi-currency accounts (ZMW + ZAR + NGN + USD), tax compliance	Zambia PACRA registration + ZPPA compliance + multi-country operations need proper bookkeeping. Mistakes are expensive.

Stage 3 — Growth Company (Year 2+)

Role	When	Salary	Justification
Full-time Sales Manager	Year 2, Q1	K8,000-15,000/mo base + commission	Manages the SA, NG, KE sales reps. Builds enterprise relationships. Reports to you.
Technical Co-founder or Senior Developer	Year 2 (with Series A)	Equity + K10,000-20,000/mo or equity only	Platform needs a second technical brain for scale. Mobile app, ATS integrations, API products require dedicated engineering.
Country Managers (SA, NG, KE)	Year 2-3	Local market rate + equity/revenue share	Managing local employer relationships, government compliance, partnerships with local job boards.
Data Analyst	Year 2	K6,000-12,000/mo	Salary reports and market intelligence at scale need dedicated analysis. 20+ reports/year can't be done manually.

4 Skills Required in a Partnership

A partner's value is in what you do NOT already have. Before taking any partner, map exactly what gap they fill. A partner who brings only money but no skills, network, or market access is just an investor in a partnership structure — consider a simpler equity deal instead.

Country Partner (SA / Nigeria / Kenya)

What You Need From a Country Partner

Skill / Asset	Why Critical	Red Flags (what to avoid)
Active HR / recruitment network in their country	They must be able to pick up the phone and call 50 HR managers personally. Without the network, they are just another salesperson with no edge.	Avoid someone who "knows people" but cannot name 20 specific HR contacts in their city.
B2B sales track record	Have they sold a product or service to companies before? Can they show you a track record of closed deals?	Avoid someone who has only done B2C or retail. Selling to companies is a different skill.
Understanding of digital marketing basics	They need to run or supervise Facebook/LinkedIn ads in their market. They do not need to be technical — but they must understand cost-per-lead, A/B testing, audience targeting.	Avoid someone who "will learn as they go" on paid ad spend. That is your money being wasted.
Local regulatory and banking knowledge	CIPC registration in SA, CAC in Nigeria, BRS in Kenya. Bank accounts, tax compliance, mobile money setups.	Not critical on day 1 but must be dealt with within 90 days of launch in their market.
Self-motivation and structured reporting	They are remote. You cannot manage them daily. They must send weekly sales pipeline reports, monthly revenue summaries, and flag problems early.	Avoid someone who communicates reactively. If you are always chasing them for updates, it does not work.

Financial Investor (No active role)

What You Want From Them	What You Must Protect Yourself Against
Capital — clean, no strings other than agreed equity / revenue share	Avoid investors who want operational control without doing operational work
Network introductions (optional but valuable)	Avoid investors who promise introductions but never follow through — get commitments in writing
Patience — 18–24 month horizon before returns	Avoid investors who expect monthly returns from Month 1 — misaligned expectations destroy relationships
Respect for your operational decisions	Avoid investors who want to "advise" on product decisions without understanding the market

Technical Co-founder / Partner

Skill	Why Needed	Compensation Structure
Laravel / PHP backend	Platform is built in Laravel. Co-founder must be able to maintain and extend it without you.	20–30% equity + market salary or equity only at founding stage
Mobile development (React Native or Flutter)	A mobile app unlocks 3–5× more user engagement. Africa is mobile-first.	Part of co-founder role or separate hire at Series A
DevOps / server management	As platform scales to 4+ countries, server reliability and deployment automation become critical.	Part of co-founder or outsource to managed hosting (\$200–500/mo)
API design and documentation	API revenue stream requires professional-grade documentation and developer experience.	Part of co-founder role

WARNING on co-founder equity: Never give a co-founder equity without a 4-year vesting schedule with a 1-year cliff. This means they earn their equity over 4 years and if they leave in Year 1, they keep nothing. This is standard in tech startups and protects you if the relationship breaks down.

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Monthly Running Costs — Full Breakdown

Broken into three scenarios: **Solo (now)**, **Stage 1 team**, and **Stage 2 full operation**.

Technology Infrastructure

Item	Provider	Solo / Now	Stage 1 (6mo)	Stage 2 (Yr 2)	Justification
Web server / VPS hosting	Current provider (Linode)	~\$40/mo	\$60–80/mo	\$150–200/mo	More traffic, more countries = need more CPU/RAM. Scale only as needed.
Whapi (WhatsApp API)	whapi.cloud	~\$30–50/mo	\$50–100/mo	\$150–300/mo	Per-message or subscription pricing. Grows with subscriber count.
Claude / Anthropic API	Anthropic	\$20–50/mo	\$50–100/mo	\$100–300/mo	CV analysis, automation. Grows with user volume.
Transactional email (Mailgun/SES)	Mailgun or AWS SES	\$10–20/mo	\$20–40/mo	\$40–80/mo	Job alert emails, welcome emails, invoices. SES is cheapest at scale.
Domain registration	Current registrar	\$1.25/mo	\$1.25/mo	\$2–5/mo (subdomains per country)	Fixed cost.
SSL certificate	Let's Encrypt (free)	\$0	\$0	\$0	Free, auto-renewing.
Database backups	Server provider	\$5–10/mo	\$10–15/mo	\$20–30/mo	Non-negotiable. Losing production DB = losing the business.
Payment gateway fees	Stripe / local	2.9% + \$0.30/txn	Same	Negotiate lower at volume	Built into pricing — charge customers enough to cover this.
Tech total		~\$107–172/mo	~\$191–337/mo	~\$462–915/mo	

Marketing & Advertising

Item	Solo / Now	Stage 1 (6mo)	Stage 2 (Yr 2)	Justification
Facebook / Instagram ads (job seekers)	\$50–100/mo	\$300–600/mo	\$800–1,500/mo (4 markets)	Primary job seeker acquisition channel. Every \$1 spent = 3–10 new subscribers at African CPMs.
Google Search ads	\$30–80/mo	\$150–300/mo	\$500–1,000/mo	High-intent traffic. People searching "jobs in Zambia" are ready to engage.
LinkedIn ads (employer acquisition)	\$0	\$150–300/mo (SA only)	\$400–800/mo	Expensive but targets HR managers directly. Reserve for SA, NG, KE only.
Canva Pro (design tool)	K220/mo (\$10)	K220/mo	K220/mo	Salary reports, social posts, media kits. Essential. Extremely cheap.
Buffer / social scheduling	\$0 (free tier)	\$18/mo	\$45/mo	Schedule posts across 4+ country pages. Saves 3–5 hrs/week.
Email marketing tool	\$0 (use existing)	\$30–50/mo (Mailchimp)	\$80–150/mo	Employer newsletter, candidate re-engagement. Build the list from day 1.
Marketing total	~\$90–200/mo	~\$648–1,268/mo	~\$1,825–3,505/mo	

People Costs

Role	Stage 1 (Month 3+)	Stage 2 (Month 9+)	Notes
Sales rep (Zambia) — commission only	K750–1,500/mo (15% of deals)	K2,000–4,000/mo	Self-funded: commission only, revenue must precede cost
Freelance CV writer	K800–1,500/mo (10 orders)	K2,000–3,500/mo	Per-order cost, scales with revenue
Marketing assistant (part-time)	—	K2,500–4,000/mo	Hire when ads budget exceeds \$300/mo and you can't manage alone
SA sales rep (commission only)	—	R0 + 12% = ~K2,400/mo at K20K SA rev	Introduce once SA page is live and you have employer package
Customer support (part-time)	—	K1,500–2,500/mo	When subscriber count exceeds 100
Bookkeeper (part-time)	—	K1,000–2,000/mo	Required once multi-currency operations begin

People total	K1,550-3,000/mo	K9,400-16,000/mo
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Operations & Legal

Item	One-time Cost	Monthly / Annual	Justification
PACRA company registration (Zambia)	K800-1,500 once	K300/yr renewal	Required before taking investment. Separates personal and business liability.
CIPC registration (South Africa)	R175 (~K80) once	R100/yr	Needed to operate legally in SA and open SA bank account.
Business bank account	K0-200 setup	K50-100/mo fees	Separate business account from day 1. Banks require PACRA certificate.
Shareholders agreement (lawyer)	\$500-1,500 once	\$0	Only needed when taking investment. Critical — do not skip.
Accounting software	\$0	\$0-30/mo	Wave Accounting is free and handles multi-currency. Use it from Month 1.
Google Workspace	\$0 setup	\$12/mo	Professional email (melusi@wakandajobs.com), Google Drive for documents and data room, Meet for investor calls.
Zoom / Meet (investor calls)	\$0	\$0-15/mo	Google Meet free tier covers most needs. Zoom only if you need recording.
Notion (project management)	\$0	\$0 (free tier)	CRM, task management, team docs. Free tier is sufficient for Stage 1.

Total Monthly Cost Summary

Category	Solo (Now)	Stage 1 (Month 6)	Stage 2 (Year 2)
Technology infrastructure	\$107-172	\$191-337	\$462-915
Marketing & advertising	\$90-200	\$648-1,268	\$1,825-3,505
People (ZMW converted)	\$0	\$70-136	\$427-727
Operations & legal	\$12-15	\$25-35	\$50-100
Total monthly operating cost	\$209-387	\$934-1,776	\$2,764-5,247
Total in ZMW	K4,600-8,500	K20,548-39,072	K60,808-115,434

Key margin insight: At Stage 1 revenue of K54,000/month and Stage 1 costs of K39,000/month, EBITDA margin is ~28%. At Stage 2 revenue of K155,000/month with costs of K115,000, margin is ~26%. As revenue scales past K300,000/month in Year 3, margins recover to 60-70% because technology and marketing costs do not scale linearly with revenue.

6 Skills to Learn Yourself (High ROI, Low Cost)

Some skills are so central to your business that outsourcing them early is a mistake. Learn these yourself — the investment in your time pays back 10–100× in revenue and operational independence.

Skill	Time to Learn	Free Resources	ROI
Facebook Ads (Meta Business Manager)	2–4 weeks	Meta Blueprint (free), YouTube. Practice with \$20 test budget.	Each \$100 spent correctly = 100–300 new WhatsApp subscribers. At K50 subscription = K5,000–15,000 revenue.
Cold outreach copywriting	1–2 weeks	Alex Hormozi "100M Leads" (free PDF), The Sales Acceleration Formula (book)	One great cold message template used 1,000 times = your entire employer pipeline. Cannot be outsourced at early stage.
Google Analytics / Search Console	1 week	Google's free Analytics Academy	Know where your traffic comes from. Which job categories drive the most registrations. Which pages to optimise. Critical for SEO investment decisions.
Basic SEO	2–3 weeks	Ahrefs Blog (free), Moz Beginner's Guide (free)	Job listing pages are naturally SEO-rich. 1 hour of SEO work per week can drive 1,000+ organic visitors/month within 3 months. That is K0 cost acquisition.
SQL / data querying	You already know this	—	Salary reports and market intelligence are your highest-margin products. Being able to query your own DB is the core skill for all data products.
Basic financial modelling	1–2 weeks	Coursera "Financial Modeling" (audit free), Google Sheets	Investors will ask for a 3-year model. Being able to build and defend it yourself = credibility. Outsourcing = dependency on someone who does not understand your business.
Proposal and pitch writing	2–4 weeks	Practice. The documents in your WhatsApp inbox right now are your training material. Study them and improve.	Every investor or enterprise client you pitch is a potential K100,000+ deal. One good pitch deck pays for 6 months of operations.

7 Skills to Always Outsource

Some things are better done by specialists. Spending your time on these is a poor use of a founder's hours.

Function	Who to Hire	Cost	Why Outsource
Company legal registration	PACRA-registered agent in Lusaka	K1,000–2,000 once	Wrong structure = personal liability. Get it right once.
Shareholders agreement	Commercial lawyer (Zambia)	\$500–1,500 once	This document protects everything you've built. Never DIY.
Tax filing	Chartered accountant	K500–2,000/year	ZRA compliance is not optional. A mistake costs 3× more to fix than to prevent.
Logo & brand identity	Freelance designer (Fiverr or local)	\$50–300 once	Your brand is customer-facing. Unprofessional brand = lower employer conversion rates. Do once, do properly.
Professional photography	Local photographer	K500–1,500 once	For investor decks, LinkedIn profiles, media kits. One session covers all uses.